The Houston Apartment Build and Building Up Houston

Lesson 7 · Wednesday, December 16, 2026 · Your task list says which page to do and when.

Part 1: Word Power

Write the best word or words from the bank in each blank. One choice is extra.

Word bank: improper fraction simplify unit fraction topic sentence transition concluding sentence

1. 1/8 has 1 as its numerator, so it is a _____.

2. 27/4 is an _____ because 27 is bigger than 4.

3. To _____ 18/24, divide the numerator and the denominator by 6.

4. *However* and *as a result* are each a _____.

5. The _____ states what a paragraph is about. It usually comes first.

Part 2: Equivalent fractions and simplest form

Multiply or divide the numerator and the denominator by the same number. Never add.

6. 3/7 = _____/28 7. 5/9 = 40/_____ 8. 7/12 = _____/60

9. Simplify **36/60** with the GCF.
Factors of 36: _____
Factors of 60: _____
GCF: _____ 36/60 = _____

10. Simplify **28/70** with the GCF.
Factors of 28: _____
Factors of 70: _____
GCF: _____ 28/70 = _____

11. Circle the TWO fractions that are equivalent to 4/7.

12/21 5/8 16/28 8/11

12. Ricky says 5/8 = 4/7 because he added 1 to the top and the bottom. Explain his mistake and write one fraction that really is equal to 4/7.

Part 3: Amara's crew

Show your work in each box. Write mixed numbers and fractions in simplest form.

13. Convert 22/5 to a mixed number.

22/5 = _____

14. Convert 7 2/3 to an improper fraction.

7 2/3 = _____

15. 72 tiles cover a lobby floor. 45 of them are blue, and every other tile is white. What fraction of the tiles are white?

_____

16. Mr. Nguyen joins 30 pieces of pipe into one line. Every piece is 1/8 foot long. How long is the line?

_____ feet

Part 4: Build a paragraph

Read the paragraph. Transition box: **First,** · **However,** · **Finally,** · **As a result,**

(1) A new apartment building goes up in stages, and a different crew handles each stage. (2) _____ surveyors use special tools to mark the corners of the lot. (3) Next, carpenters and ironworkers build the frame. (4) My cousin plays the trumpet in a band. (5) _____ painters give every wall two coats of paint. (6) Thanks to all of these crews, an empty lot becomes a place where families can live.

17. Best transition for blank (2): _____ blank (5): _____

18. Which sentence is off-topic? Sentence _____

19. Sentence 6 is the …

topic sentence | concluding sentence | off-topic sentence

20. Write your own informative paragraph (4 to 6 sentences): how to fold your best paper airplane. Use a topic sentence, at least two transitions, and a concluding sentence.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · MATH

The Houston Apartment Build

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: Fractions on the Building Site

Amara is helping build an apartment building in Houston. Before the lesson, warm up with these problems. Show your work.

1 Diego's tile floor is a rectangle split into 4 equal tiles, and 2 of them are blue. Draw it. Then write two different fractions that name the blue part.

2 Which fraction is equal to 1/2?

2/3 3/6 2/5 1/4

3 Fill in the missing number: 1/3 = ?/6

4 Match each word to its meaning. Write the letter next to each word.

___ **numerator**	**A.** the bottom number of a fraction
___ **denominator**	**B.** fractions that name the same amount
___ **equivalent fractions**	**C.** the top number of a fraction

5 Review (Week 11): List all the factors of 12 and all the factors of 18. Circle the greatest common factor.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · MATH

The Houston Apartment Build

Name: _____ Date: _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Challenge: Inspection Report

Use equivalent fractions, simplest form, and mixed numbers to finish Amara's report. Show your work.

1. Diego tiles a hallway with 30 tiles, and 12 of them are blue. What fraction of the tiles are blue? Write it in simplest form and name the GCF you divided by.

2. Write three fractions that are equivalent to 2/3. Show the n/n you multiplied by each time.

3. Which mixed number equals 23/6?

   3 5/6 3 1/6 5 3/6 6 3/5

4. Darnell needs a piece of rebar that is 4 5/8 feet long. Write the length as an improper fraction and show how you got it.

5. Writing: Amara's cousin says, "9/12 is in simplest form because 9 is odd and 12 is even." In two or three complete sentences, explain whether he is right. Use the words greatest common factor and simplest form.

★ **Challenge:** Find a fraction that is equivalent to 3/4, has a denominator between 30 and 40, and has a numerator that is a multiple of 9. Explain how you found it.

Looking Ahead: Next week (Week 13) we travel to a mountain village in Peru, where we will multiply fractions by whole numbers and by other fractions.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: Building a Paragraph

Before the lesson, show what you already know about how paragraphs are built. Do your best. It is fine to guess!

1. Which sentence would make the best TOPIC sentence for a paragraph about building on clay soil?

   Clay soil makes building a foundation tricky. | The crew eats lunch at noon. | My favorite color is brown.

2. Circle the transition word, then write its job (order, example, contrast, or effect): The rain lasted all day. As a result, the crew stayed home.

3. Cross out the sentence that does NOT belong: Cranes lift heavy loads. They can lift steel beams to the top floor. I like tacos. Some cranes are taller than the building.

4. Add the missing comma: Next the crew pours the concrete.

5. Review (Week 11): Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   "Watch the crane," Andre said. | "Watch the crane." Andre said. | "Watch the crane", Andre said.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

Now use everything you practiced today: topic sentences, supporting details, transition words, and concluding sentences.

1. Write the letters in the best order to make a paragraph: A. Next, they tie steel bars into grids. B. Building the frame takes teamwork. C. Finally, concrete is poured around the steel. D. First, workers set up the forms.

2. Fill in each blank with the best transition (however, for example, as a result): Houston gets strong storms. _____, builders install thick windows. Many workers help. _____, electricians run wires. Concrete cracks when stretched. _____, steel is strong when stretched.

3. Find the off-topic sentence and write a better supporting detail to replace it: Inspectors keep buildings safe. They check the foundation. My uncle has a red truck. They test the wiring.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON · CONTINUED

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

4 Rewrite with correct capitals and commas: first the crew in houston pours concrete. however the rain slows them down.

5 Writing: Write an informative paragraph (5 to 6 sentences) about a building, bridge, barn or other structure in your community. Include a topic sentence, at least three supporting details, at least two transition words, and a concluding sentence. Underline your topic sentence and circle your transitions.

★ **Challenge:** Write a two-paragraph informative piece about how something in your community is built or made (a house, a garden, a road, a quilt, or a meal). Give each paragraph its own topic sentence and main idea, use at least four different transition words, and end the second paragraph with a concluding sentence that wraps up both.

Looking Ahead: Week 13: Figurative language and poetry. You will explore similes, metaphors and personification in original poems set in a mountain village in Peru.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 6 · SOCIAL STUDIES

The Colonies and Who Built Them

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Do I Already Know?

Write what you know right now. Guesses are fine; this is your starting point.

1. What have you heard about Jamestown, Plymouth or Pocahontas? Write two things.

2. Who was already living on the land where the English built their colonies? Write what you know or guess.

3. Prediction: Why might an Indigenous nation choose to trade with colonists? Why might it choose to resist them?

4. Guess: Why would a colony need many workers? What kinds of work would they do?

5. Write one question you have about the first colonies.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 6 · SOCIAL STUDIES

The Colonies and Who Built Them

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Did I Learn?

Use evidence from today's lesson. Write in complete sentences.

1. Using John Rolfe's letter as evidence, explain how the first Africans came to Virginia in 1619 and what the letter shows about Rolfe's point of view.

2. Choose Matoaka (Pocahontas), Massasoit or Anthony Johnson. Tell that person's story honestly in two or three sentences.

3. Compare William Penn's treaties with the 1737 Walking Purchase. How were they different?

4. Who benefited from Virginia's tobacco, and who paid the cost?

★ **Challenge:** Many old books call Plymouth's 1621 harvest feast "the first Thanksgiving" and show only friendly neighbors. Write a more complete caption for that picture, using two facts from today's lesson.

Looking Ahead: Next week we study how slavery grew in the colonies and how enslaved Africans resisted and kept their cultures alive. Bring this question: how could a colony's laws make slavery last from one generation to the next?